

extension. A downward volume trend suggests higher volume as price rises on the left side of the V and diminished volume as price slides downward and forms the extension. I've shown the volume trend (with sloping lines on the volume scale, such as point E in [Figure 72.3](#)) in the figures accompanying this chapter.

Rising/Falling volume. Extended V-tops with falling volume tend to outperform those with rising volume, but only in bear markets. Bull markets show no preference.

Breakout day volume. Usually high breakout day volume helps performance, but with downward breakouts that's often difficult to see. In bull markets, heavy (above the prior month's average) breakout volume helps performance, but in bear markets it hurts performance. The results are close enough in either case to be a meaningless comparison.

Table 72.7 is supposed to show where to place the stop, but that table is only meaningful for patterns with breakouts at the top or bottom of the pattern. I don't show the table. Maybe you have to read between the lines to see it.

[Table 72.6](#) Volume Statistics

Description	Bull Market	Bear Market
Volume trend	83% down	89% down
Rising volume trend performance	-18%	-23%
Falling volume trend performance	-18%	-26%
Heavy breakout volume performance	-19%	-25%
Light breakout volume performance	-18%	-26%